

Enterprise Financial Planning Dashboard

A 6-page Power BI solution that unifies Budget, Actual and Forecast across 5 entities, 8 departments and 120 cost centers, so finance leaders see variance and forecast quality in one place.

Power BI

DAX

Power Query

FP&A

Oracle EPM (PBCS) concepts

7.09bn

Total Budget

7.27bn

Total Actual

7.45bn

Total Forecast

181M

Variance

97.50%

Forecast Accuracy

120

Cost Centers

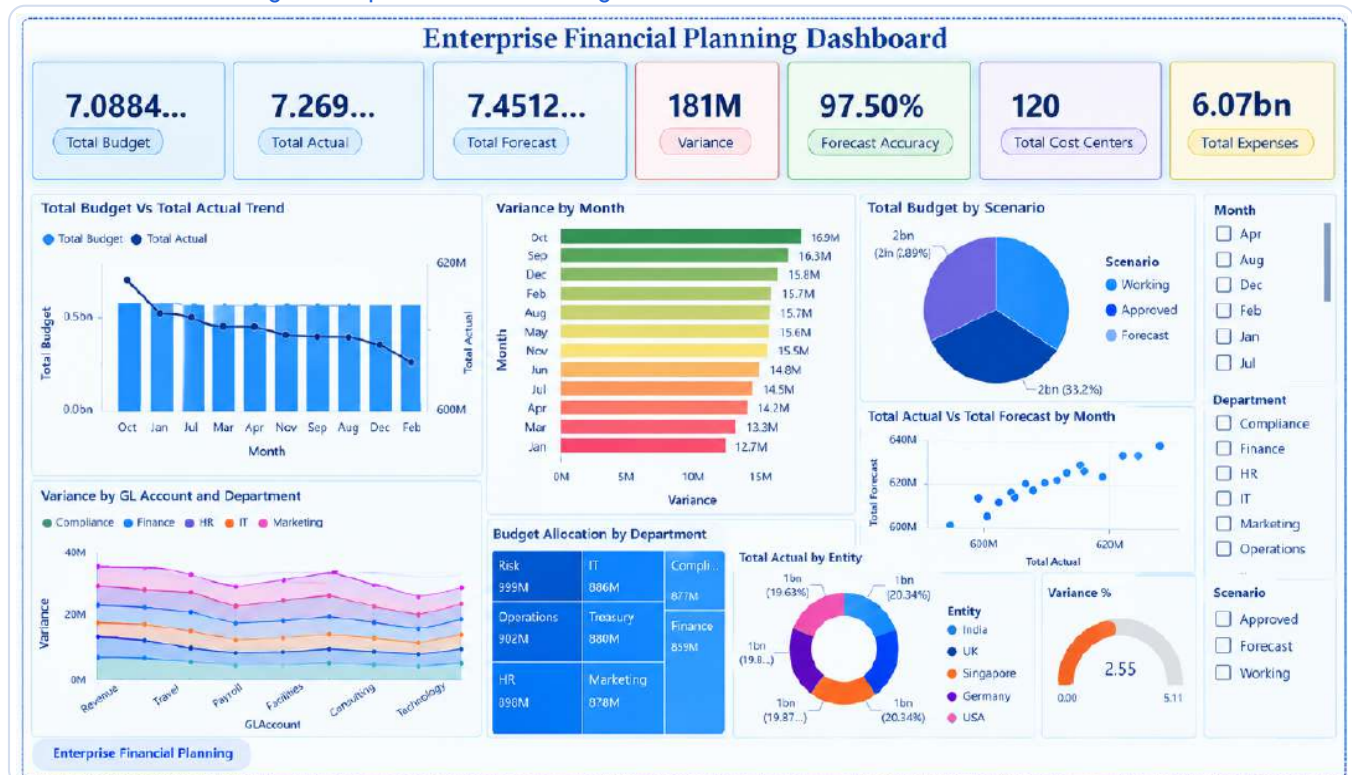
6.07bn

Total Expenses

Project snapshot

Domain	Enterprise performance management: budgeting, forecasting and variance analysis
Objective	Replace separate budget, actual and forecast reports with one interactive view that explains where and why spend deviates from plan
Scope	5 entities (India, UK, Singapore, Germany, USA), 8 departments, 120 cost centers, 6 GL accounts, 3 scenarios (Working, Approved, Forecast), 12 fiscal months
Deliverable	6-page interactive Power BI report with slicers for Month, Department, Scenario and Account Type
Tech stack	Power BI Desktop, Power Query (M), DAX, star-schema model; dimensions mirror an Oracle EPM (PBCS) planning cube
Project type	Portfolio / analytics case study

DASHBOARD PREVIEW | Page 1: Enterprise Financial Planning



01 BUSINESS CONTEXT

Problem, objectives and solution architecture

Finance teams often hold **budget, actuals and forecast in different files**, so explaining a variance means reconciling several reports before any analysis starts. This dashboard brings the three views together on one governed model and lets leaders slice by entity, department, cost center, GL account and scenario.

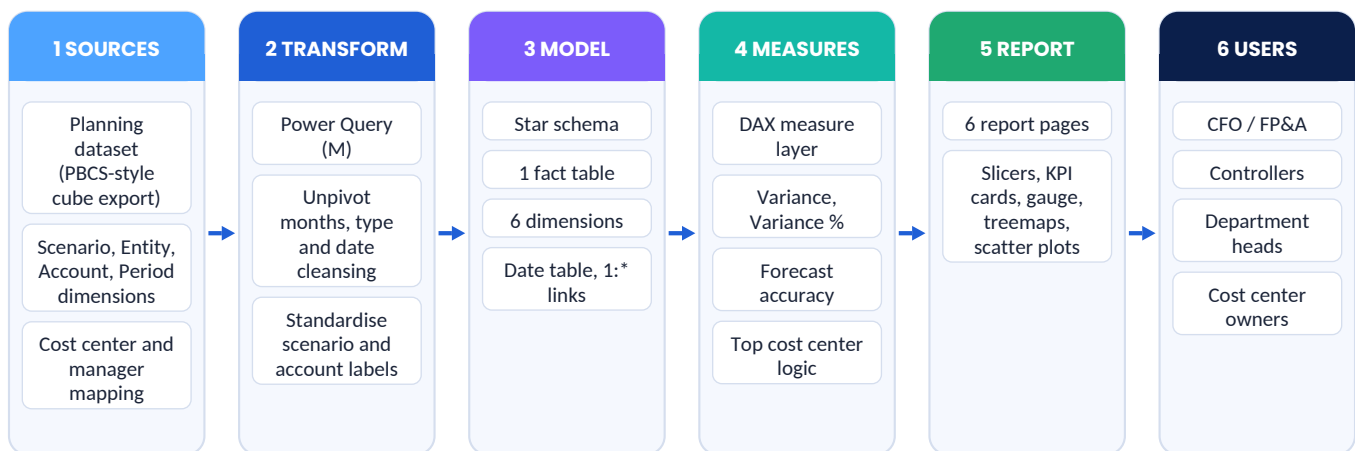
The challenge

- Budget, actual and forecast live in separate reports
- Variance explanations take days of manual reconciliation
- Forecast quality is not measured, only discussed
- No quick way to find the cost centers driving overspend

Objectives

- Show **Budget vs Actual vs Forecast** in one executive view
- Quantify **variance** by month, scenario, entity and department
- Track **forecast accuracy** by month, entity and account type
- Rank **cost centers** by variance and spend
- Break down **expenses** by GL account, department and entity

Solution architecture



Planning cycle supported



Report coverage by finance question

Finance question	Dashboard page
How far are we from budget overall, and by month?	Enterprise Financial Planning, Variance Analysis
Which departments, GL accounts and entities carry the gap?	Total Actual Analysis
How reliable is our forecast?	Forecast Analysis
Which cost centers drive the variance?	Variance Analysis, Cost Center Analysis
Where is money actually being spent?	Expense Analysis

02 DATA MODEL AND MEASURES

Star schema, DAX logic and validation

A single planning fact table carries Budget, Actual and Forecast side by side. Six dimensions mirror the structure of an EPM planning application, so every visual can be filtered by the same business dimensions.



Logical model reflecting the fields used in the report. Relationships are one-to-many, single direction from dimension to fact.

Key DAX measures

```

measures.dax

// Core
Total Budget = SUM( Planning[Budget] )
Total Actual = SUM( Planning[Actual] )
Total Forecast = SUM( Planning[Forecast] )
// Variance and forecast quality
Variance = [Total Actual] - [Total Budget]
Variance % = DIVIDE( [Variance], [Total Budget] )
Forecast Accuracy = 1 - DIVIDE( ABS( [Total Forecast] - [Total Actual] ), [Total Actual] )
// Spend and ranking
Total Expenses = CALCULATE( [Total Actual], DimGL[AccountType] = "Expense" )
Cost Centers = DISTINCTCOUNT( Planning[CostCenter] )
Highest Spend CC = INDEX( 1, ALLSELECTED( DimCostCenter[CostCenter] ), ORDERBY( [Total Actual], DESC ) )
  
```

Validation and quality checks

- Reconciliation:** Variance 180,995,994 = Actual 7,269,450,752 - Budget 7,088,454,758, which equals the 2.55% on the gauge.
- Forecast accuracy check:** Forecast 7.451bn vs Actual 7.269bn gives a 2.50% gap, hence the 97.50% KPI.
- Cross-page consistency:** department forecast totals add to 7,451,217,765, matching the executive KPI.
- Power Query:** typed columns, standardised scenario and account names, removed blanks and duplicates.

Data dictionary: key fields

Field	Definition	Used in
Scenario	Planning version: Working, Approved or Forecast	All pages (slider)
Budget / Actual / Forecast	Planned, realised and projected amounts per month, cost center and GL account	All pages
AccountType	Expense or Income classification of the GL account	Expense Analysis
CostCenter, Manager	Owner hierarchy for accountability and drill-down	Cost Center Analysis

03 DASHBOARD WALKTHROUGH

Navigation design and page-by-page guide

The report opens on an **executive overview** and branches into five analytical pages. Slicers for Month, Department and Scenario sit in the same right-hand panel on each page, so a filter set once carries the same meaning everywhere.

Click a node to jump to its walkthrough



1 Total Actual Analysis: budget vs actual by department, GL account, entity, manager and month



2 Forecast Analysis: forecast vs actual, accuracy by entity, account type and month



3 Variance Analysis: top 10 cost centers, variance by scenario, month, department, entity



4 Cost Center Analysis: spend by cost center, mix by department and GL, highest-spending unit



5 Expense Analysis: GL account mix, expense trend, department matrix, entity treemap

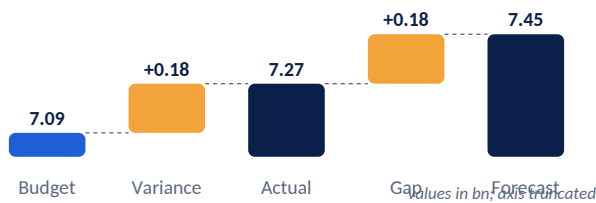
Reading the pages

Overview is page 1. Each of the 5 pages answers one question: Where is spend vs plan? How good is the forecast? Where is variance? Which cost centers? What are we spending on?

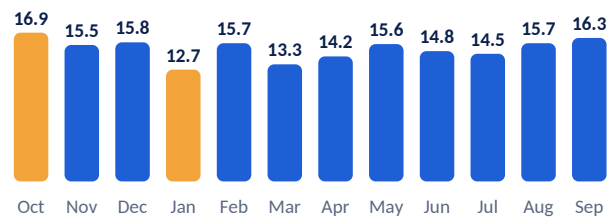
04 INSIGHTS AND OUTCOMES

What the data says and what to do about it

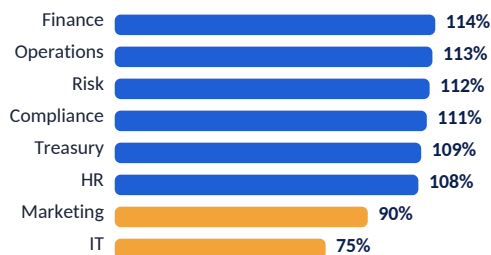
Budget to Actual to Forecast (bn)



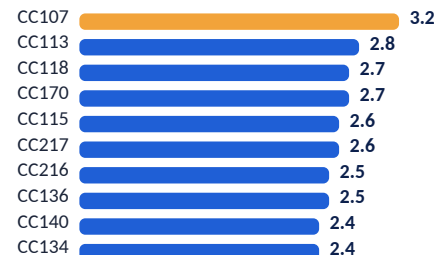
Variance by month (M)



Forecast as % of actual, by department (approx.)



Top 10 cost centers by variance (M)



Key findings

- Consistent overspend:** actuals exceed budget by **181M (2.55%)**, and every month is over, from 12.7M (Jan) to 16.9M (Oct). A steady gap points to an under-set baseline, not a one-off event.
- Broad-based, not local:** variance is spread almost evenly across the 5 entities (about 19-21% each, 35-38M), with Risk, Operations and Compliance the largest departmental contributors.
- Forecast looks strong at the top:** 97.50% accuracy overall. **Underneath, errors offset:** most departments are forecast 8-14% above actual while IT (about 25% below) and Marketing (about 10% below) are under-forecast.
- Concentration:** the top 10 of 120 cost centers (8%) account for about 26M, roughly **15% of total variance**; CC107 leads at 3.2M, while CC134 is the highest-spending unit.
- Spend is trending down:** monthly expenses fall from about 514M (Oct) to about 495M (Sep), around 3.7% lower.

Recommendations

Focus area	Recommended action	KPI to watch
Baseline	Re-base budgets by 2-3% or document the drivers of recurring overspend	Variance %
Forecast bias	Review IT and Marketing driver assumptions; add department-level accuracy targets	Dept forecast accuracy
Cost centers	Run monthly reviews with owners of the top 10 variance cost centers	Top 10 variance (M)
Scenarios	Compare Working vs Approved vs Forecast to see where changes enter the plan	Variance by scenario

Skills demonstrated

Power BI | DAX | Power Query | Star-schema modeling | FP&A; and variance analysis | Forecast accuracy | EPM planning concepts | KPI design | Storytelling

Business value

One governed view replaces three reports, cuts reconciliation time and moves the conversation from *what is the number* to *what should we change*.